



Drawing first blood: Jasprit Bumrah clean bowled opener Reeza Hendricks to deal an early blow to the chase.

Right: Heinrich Klaasen's quickfire 52 took South Africa close to the target before the tables turned dramatically.

K. R. DEEPAK

Buttler's captaincy.

England's arch-rival, Australia, fared even worse, crashing out after back-to-back losses in the Super 8s and failing to reach the finals of the ICC flagship event for the second consecutive time. **David Warner's departure leaves a significant gap at the top of the order. The 37-year-old exits as his country's leading men's T20I run-scorer, amassing 3,277 runs at an average of 33.43.**

Jake Fraser-McGurk is likely to fill Warner's spot. He impressed during the last IPL season, representing the Delhi Capitals and scoring 330 runs in nine innings at a strike rate exceeding 200. Warner even posted a photo on social media of the pair drinking by the pool with the caption — 'All yours now, champion'.



The Australian selectors must also consider the ageing squad, as only Tim David (28) and Nathan Ellis (29) were under 30 among the 13 players used in this T20 World Cup. By the time of the next edition, Glenn Maxwell will be 37, Marcus Stoinis 36, Mitchell Starc 36, and Josh

Hazlewood 35, indicating that the T20 team may need an overhaul.

Meanwhile, the early exit of co-host West Indies robbed the event of its festive fervour. Though fans were disappointed with the result, they could not fault the effort. **Rovman Powell's men, serenaded by Calypso legend David Rudder's live rendition of the anthem, *Rally Round the West Indies*, before the games, brought large crowds back to the stadium.** "When you look on a large scale, we haven't won the World Cup. We aren't in the semi-finals," Powell had said earlier. "But I think the cricket we have played in the last 12 months is commendable. Credit has to be given to the team. If you can move from number 9 to number 3 in the world in a